Clementina Crocè

clementina.croce@unipd.it | clementinacroce.github.io

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Labour Economics; Economics of Education; Gender Economics; Development Economics.

ACADEMIC APPOINTMENTS

Postdoctoral Researcher, University of Padua, Italy 2023–Present

Projects: Skills2Capabilities, Horizon Europe programme (2023–2025). Student incentives and academic performance; educational choices in the transition from upper-secondary school to university (2026).

Research visits

- London School of Economics and Political Science, UK Jun 2026
- FBK–IRVAPP, Trento, Italy Jul 2025–May 2026
- Federal Institute for Vocational Education and Training (BIBB), Bonn, Germany May–Jun 2025
- Research Centre for Education and the Labour Market (ROA), Maastricht University, Netherlands Mar–Apr 2025

Postdoctoral Researcher, University of Trento, Italy 2021–2022

Project: Altruism, bargaining power, and children's outcomes.

EDUCATION

PhD, Development Economics, University of Trento & University of Florence, Italy 2021

Thesis: Essays on Migration and Gender.
Supervisor: Gabriella Berloffa. *External referees*: Michael Vlassopoulos; Isabelle Chort.
Research visit: University of Southampton, UK Jan–Jul 2020

Master, International Management (*cum laude*), University of Modena and Reggio Emilia, Italy 2017

Thesis: What causes refugee migration? An empirical investigation of panel data.
Training programme, University of International Business and Economics, Beijing, China (2016).

Bachelor, Economics, University of Modena and Reggio Emilia, Italy 2014

JOB MARKET PAPER

When Conscription Ends: Labour Supply and the Apprenticeship Market
with Caroline Neuber-Pohl (BIBB, Bonn)

RESEARCH OUTPUT

Publications

Peer-reviewed

Teacher personality and the perceived socioeconomic gap in student outcomes
with Giorgio Brunello, Pamela Giustinelli and Lorenzo Rocco
Economics Letters (2025), 247, 112096. Paper

Working Papers

Does work-based learning facilitate the school-to-work transition? Evidence from an Italian reform
with Martino Bernardi, Marco Bertoni, Giorgio Brunello and Lorenzo Rocco
IZA Discussion Paper No. 17352 (2024). *Under review*.

Abstract of the latest manuscript. In 2015, Italy made work-based learning compulsory in all upper secondary schools, with the declared purpose of improving graduates' employment prospects. We provide the first causal evaluation of the reform using a model-based counterfactual estimated on pre-reform cohorts and validated out-of-sample on two pre-reform placebo cohorts and through the Rambachan and Roth (2023) sensitivity framework. In the most intensively treated group – technical-track graduates – employment one year after graduation declined by 3.5 percentage points for males and 3.4 percentage points for females, about 12 to 14 percent of the pre-reform mean. For academic-track graduates, who were exposed to half as many mandated hours of work-based learning, the effect was close to zero. University enrolment is near its counterfactual for both tracks, ruling out substitution toward higher education. We discuss several candidate mechanisms consistent with the negative effects on employment.

Research Reports

Educational pathways and the choice of high school tracks
with Giorgio Brunello, Pamela Giustinelli and Lorenzo Rocco (2025). Report

Country case studies on skills strategies, the Italian case study
with Giorgio Brunello and Lorenzo Rocco (2024). Report

Data and Research Materials

Survey data. Survey of teachers on the formulation of school track recommendations.
Pilot completed in summer 2023. Main data collection in winter–spring 2025.
Data archived at GESIS.

Interview data. Semi-structured interviews with practitioners and policy experts on skills and lifelong learning strategies; responsiveness of VET; work-based learning in Italy.
Fieldwork: autumn 2023, winter–spring 2024, and winter 2025.
Data archived at Zenodo 1; Zenodo 2; Zenodo 3.

Work in Progress

- **High school choice recommendations: Survey evidence from Italian teachers**
with Giorgio Brunello, Pamela Giustinelli and Lorenzo Rocco
Drafting.
- **Gender gaps in STEM-related skills: Survey evidence from lower-secondary school students**
with Santiago Franco Aixela, Maria Giulia Ballatore, Sara Bernardini, Sergiu Burlacu, Giacomo Como, Alexandra Neacsu, Alessandro Tondini and Martina Vanelli
Drafting.
- **Conservation against local growth? Assessing the economic consequences of marine protection**
with Fabio Cevenini, Carlo Fezzi and Rosario Guaia
Data analysis and drafting.
- **Women's bargaining power and investments in children's human capital**
with Gabriella Berloffa and Elie Murard
Data analysis and drafting.

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Courses and lectures

Microeconometrics, Stata Lab, PhD Programme, University of Padua	2023–2026
Human Capital and Health, Master's Programme, University of Padua	2023
Applied Economics, Master's Programme, University of Trento	2021–2023; 2025; 2026 (scheduled)

Teaching assistantships

Introduction to Economics, Undergraduate Programme, University of Trento 2021–2023

Market Analysis, Undergraduate Programme, University of Trento 2021–2022

Thesis co-supervision

Undergraduate thesis: "Analysis of returns to higher education in Italy" (2022).

Master's thesis: "Education gender gap and demographic transition in developing countries" (2021).

SEMINARS AND CONFERENCES

2026 — INVALSI Conference, "Evaluation and Research in Education" (scheduled); dSEA internal seminar, University of Padua (scheduled); Brown Bag Seminar, University of Verona (scheduled).

2025 — Trento Applied Micro Work-in-Progress Seminar Series (TAM–WiPSS); Horizon Europe Skills2Capabilities final conference; FBK–IRVAPP internal seminar; dSEA PhD & postdoc seminar, University of Padua; "Impact of vocational education and training on individuals, firms, and society" workshop, University of Bergamo; World Labour Conference EALE–SOLE–AASLE (accepted); BIBB Bonn internal seminar; ROA internal seminar, Maastricht University; seminar, Polytechnic of Milan.

2024 — Brucchi Luchino Labour Economics Workshop; University of Padua internal seminar; Italian Association of Labour Economics (AIEL) conference.

2023 — "Gender Issues and Development" workshop, Paris Nanterre University; seminar, University of Modena and Reggio Emilia; "Human Capital, Labour Markets and Public Policies" workshop, University of Naples Federico II.

2022 — Italian Economic Association (SIE) conference; European Association of Labour Economists (EALE) conference.

2021 — Workshop on Decision-Making, University of Trento; Migration Summer School workshop, Paris School of Economics; RGS Doctoral Conference in Economics.

2020 — PhD Economics Virtual Seminar Series; internal seminar, University of Southampton.

2019 — "Gender and Economics" workshop, University of Luxembourg; Joint Interdisciplinary Graduate Conference, Pompeu Fabra University.

RESEARCH FUNDING

Department of Economics and Management, University of Padua (€2,000) 2025

Department of Economics and Management, University of Padua (€2,300) 2024

Department of Economics and Management, University of Padua (€2,000) 2024

PhD scholarship, University of Trento & University of Florence 2017–2021

PROFESSIONAL SERVICE

Refereeing

Economics of Education Review; Environmental and Resource Economics; Journal of Economic Behavior & Organization; Journal of Family and Economic Issues; Journal of Industrial and Business Economics; Oxford Economic Papers; Studies in Higher Education.

Institutional responsibilities

Representative of junior researchers, University of Padua 2025

Representative of PhD students in Development Economics, University of Trento & University of Florence 2017–2020

Conference and event organisation

Member of the expert group for a conference session, INVALSI Conference "Evaluation and Research in Education" (scheduled) 2026

Public event on educational orientation, with the regional school authority for Veneto 2024

Horizon Europe Skills2Capabilities conference 2024

PUBLIC ENGAGEMENT AND MEDIA

Public talks

Higher education and mismatch in the labour market 2025

Perspectives on educational guidance in Italian lower-secondary schools 2024

Policy articles and media coverage

Lavoce.info: article on work-based learning, with Bernardi, Bertoni, Brunello, and Rocco. 2025

Il Mattino di Padova: coverage of Brunello, Crocè, Giustinelli, and Rocco (2025). 2025

ADDITIONAL INFORMATION

Affiliations

Affiliate, Global Labor Organization (GLO)

Honorary Fellow, University of Modena and Reggio Emilia 2017–2021

Research skills

Impact evaluation methods: Difference-in-differences; instrumental variables; regression discontinuity design; matching and reweighting; model-based counterfactuals.
Survey research: Survey experiments; questionnaire design and programming; data collection.
Data: Administrative and survey data at the individual, household, and firm levels.
Software: Advanced in Stata, LimeSurvey, and LaTeX; familiar with Python, R, and GIS mapping tools.

Additional training

Workshop on artificial intelligence in research, University of Padua 2026

The evolution of gender in the labour market, ROCKWOOL Foundation Berlin masterclass 2025

Migration Economics: Development impacts of migration and challenges in global labour markets, Paris School of Economics Summer School 2021

Randomised controlled trials in Development Economics: Design and data analysis, Barcelona School of Economics Summer School 2021

Foundations of Data Science with Python and R, Barcelona School of Economics Data Science Winter School 2021

Investment choices in developing economies, Summer School in International and Development Economics 2021

Quantitative methods for public policy evaluation, Barcelona School of Economics Summer School 2019

Summer School in Development Economics, Italian Association of Development Economists 2018

Family, Human Capital and Development, Summer School in International and Development Economics 2017

Languages

Italian (native); English (fluent); French (intermediate).

REFERENCES

Giorgio Brunello
University of Padua
giorgio.brunello@unipd.it

Lorenzo Rocco
University of Padua
lorenzo.rocco@unipd.it

Pamela Giustinelli
University of Padua
pamela.giustinelli@unipd.it

Sandra McNally
London School of Economics;
University of Surrey
s.mcnally1@lse.ac.uk

Gabriella Berloffa
University of Trento
gabriella.berloffa@unitn.it